

Course Comments / Assessment Summary

Assessment of student performance indicates variation across performance indicators related to written communication. Students demonstrated the strongest performance on PI1, PI2, PI4, and PI5, particularly when provided with structured templates, examples, and guiding questions. These supports helped students effectively organize and present their work.

Performance on PI6 and PI7 was significantly lower. These indicators require the use of ACS citation style, which is unfamiliar to many students who have primarily been trained in MLA or APA formats. As a result, students struggled with properly formatting references, particularly when completing citations manually.

In addition, some students demonstrated difficulty with basic document formatting requirements, such as setting 1-inch margins. This suggests gaps in technical writing and document preparation skills that impact overall communication quality.

Course Reflections

Students benefit from structured guidance when developing written communication; however, they show less proficiency when required to apply formatting conventions and citation styles independently. The difficulty with ACS style indicates a lack of prior exposure, while formatting issues suggest gaps in basic technical skills that are expected at this level.

These challenges highlight the need for reinforcing not only content organization but also professional communication standards, including formatting and citation practices.

Planned Improvements

• Instructional Support:

Provide brief instruction and examples on ACS citation style, including access to reliable resources and reference guides.

• Templates and Scaffolding:

Continue using structured templates and guiding questions to support organization and clarity in written communication.

• Technical Skill Reinforcement:

Provide supplemental resources or tutorials on basic document formatting (e.g., margins, spacing) to address gaps in Microsoft Word proficiency.

• Practice Opportunities:

Incorporate low-stakes assignments that require proper citation and formatting to reinforce expectations before major submissions.

• Communication Emphasis:

Increase emphasis on professional presentation standards, including correct formatting and citation, as part of grading criteria.